

How to Stop Worrying and Start Living

Twenty-eight practical principles — Dale Carnegie

01 LIVE IN DAY-TIGHT COMPARTMENTS

Concentrate everything on today; seal off yesterday and tomorrow.

02 WILLIS CARRIER'S MAGIC FORMULA

Worst case → accept it → calmly improve on it.

03 WHAT WORRY MAY DO TO YOU

Worry is physically destructive; fighting it is a survival skill.

04 THE THREE-STEP PROBLEM ANALYSIS

Get the facts → analyze on paper → decide and act, then don't look back.

05 THE FOUR QUESTIONS FOR BUSINESS WORRY

Make every problem answer four written questions before it gets discussed.

06 CROWD WORRY OUT BY KEEPING BUSY

Stay so busy with constructive work that worry can't get a foothold.

07 DON'T LET THE BEETLES GET YOU DOWN

Don't let the beetles take what the storms couldn't.

08 USE THE LAW OF AVERAGES

Run the numbers before you run the worry.

09 COOPERATE WITH THE INEVITABLE

Stop fighting what cannot be changed; redirect that energy.

10 PUT A STOP-LOSS ORDER ON YOUR WORRIES

Cap the price you're willing to pay — in life — for any worry.

11 DON'T TRY TO SAW SAWDUST

Extract the lesson from the past, then close the file.

12 EIGHT WORDS THAT CAN TRANSFORM YOUR LIFE

Act cheerful and you'll feel cheerful; the feeling follows the action.

13 THE HIGH COST OF GETTING EVEN

Resentment costs you sleep, health, and joy — the enemy pays nothing.

14 EXPECT INGRATITUDE — GIVE FOR THE JOY

Give for the joy of giving; treat any thanks as a bonus.

15 COUNT YOUR BLESSINGS, NOT YOUR TROUBLES

Count the 90 percent that's right before you fret the 10 percent that's wrong.

16 FIND YOURSELF AND BE YOURSELF

Be yourself — a first-rate you beats a second-rate anyone else.

17 MAKE LEMONADE FROM LEMONS

Ask what this lemon teaches you, then squeeze it.

18 FORGET YOURSELF BY SERVING OTHERS

Please someone else every day and you'll cure yourself in the process.

19 THE POWER OF PRAYER AND FAITH

Unburden your worry — in words, to a power greater than yourself or simply to paper.

20 NO ONE EVER KICKS A DEAD DOG

Unjust criticism is often proof you're doing something worth noticing.

21 PUT UP YOUR UMBRELLA

Do the very best you can, then let criticism run off your back.

22 KEEP AN FTD FOLDER

Beat your critics to it — be your own harshest reviewer first.

23 REST BEFORE YOU GET TIRED

Rest before you're tired, like your heart does — 15 hours out of every 24.

24 LEARN TO RELAX WHILE YOU WORK

The brain is tireless; it's the emotional tension around the work that exhausts you.

25 TALK IT OUT

Share the worry with someone you trust; the words themselves begin the healing.

26 FOUR GOOD WORKING HABITS

Clear the desk. Prioritize. Decide now. Delegate.

27 MAKE BORING WORK INTERESTING

Interest kills fatigue. Act interested and the real interest follows.

28 STOP WORRYING ABOUT INSOMNIA

No one was ever killed by insomnia. The worry about it is what does the damage.

What to Do — by When You Need It

Pin to a wall. Keep in a notebook. Reach for the column that matches the moment.

PHASE 1

IMMEDIATE

When worry strikes

- **Shut the Iron Doors**

The moment a worry hits, picture pressing a button that drops a bulkhead on yesterday and tomorrow. Your job for the next hour is the work in front of you.

- **Run the Carrier Formula in Three Lines**

Open a notepad. Line one: the absolute worst that can happen is... Line two: I accept that. Line three: the way I improve on the worst is... The relief between lines two

- **Get Busy on Something Constructive**

The mind can't hold two thoughts at once. Pick something that requires active planning — a repair, a call, a chapter. Not consumption. Building.

- **Act Cheerful Before You Feel It**

Shoulders back, real smile, hum or whistle. William James proved the feeling follows the action. Lowell Thomas walked Oxford Street broke, every morning, with

- **Write the Four Questions**

Problem, cause, solutions, recommendation. Most problems solve themselves during the writing.

- **Do Something for Someone Else**

Alfred Adler's 14-day prescription. Ask the postman about his day. Compliment the person behind the counter. Self-absorption is the fuel worry runs on. Cut the

- **Pray or Journal the Worry**

Putting the worry into words — to God, to paper, to a trusted friend — clarifies it and releases the pressure of carrying it alone. The words themselves begin the

PHASE 2

ANALYTICAL

Sit down with paper

- **Collect Facts as a Lawyer for the Other Side**

When worried, your emotions stack the evidence. Counter it: collect every fact that argues against your preferred view. Write both columns. Truth lives between

- **Examine the Actual Record**

In your own past similar situations, how often did the worst case occur? Jim Grant checked 25,000 carloads: only 5 ever wrecked. The worry vanished.

- **Set the Stop-Loss**

Before re-engaging, decide the limit. How many minutes, days, or dollars does this worry get? Without a stop-loss you'll trade more life than it's worth.

- **Check If You're Sawing Sawdust**

Is this about something already done? The only move is to extract the lesson and close the file.

- **Apply the Niebuhr Diagnostic**

Changeable or inevitable? If changeable, summon courage and act. If inevitable, summon serenity and accept. Most paralysis comes from confusing the two.

- **Keep an FTD Folder**

Write down your own blunders. Review them weekly like H.P. Howell. When criticism arrives, check: could it be right? Darwin spent 15 years criticizing his own

- **Use the Four Working Habits**

Clear the desk. Do things in priority order. Decide on the spot when you have the facts. Delegate.

PHASE 3

DAILY

Build long-term resistance

- **Count Blessings Before News**

First action of the day: name five specific things you have. Not abstractions. The legs you walked on. The water you drank. The person you slept beside.

- **Refuse Minutes on Enemies**

Eisenhower's rule: never waste a minute thinking about people you don't like. Hang up internally every time.

- **Despise the Trifles**

When stuck in mosquito-infested woods, make a whistle. The daily trifles will kill most of us, not the big disasters. Say it aloud: life is too short for this.

- **Give Without Expecting Thanks**

Carnegie's parents sent money yearly to an orphanage they never visited. The joy was in the giving. Notice when you're keeping score — that's the moment to stop.

- **Rest Before You're Tired**

Churchill napped three times a day during the war. A five-minute nap helped Connie Mack survive a double-header. Do what your heart does: rest between

- **Relax Your Eyes and Your Muscles**

Close your eyes and say let go for one minute. Check four times a day: am I tensing muscles that have nothing to do with this task? Think of yourself as an old crumpled

- **Make Boring Work Interesting**

Turn the dull task into a contest. Give yourself a pep talk. You spend half your waking hours at work — finding interest there is half the battle for happiness.

- **Be Unapologetically Yourself**

Each week, notice one place you were performing instead of being yourself. Try the authentic version in a low-stakes setting. First-rate you beats second-rate

- **Squeeze Every Lemon**

When something bad happens, force the question within 24 hours: what can I learn from this? The north wind made the Vikings. The constraint often is the asset.

- **Accept What You Cannot Sleep Away**

If sleep won't come, don't fight it. Get up and work, or lie still and say: I don't care. The worry about insomnia does the damage, not the insomnia itself.